

Name: Trajian Smith
Mobile App Development
01/19/2026

a) What is a .gitignore file, and why is it important in a Git project? Provide examples of files or directories you might include in it. (3 points).

This is a file that tells git what files and directories not to track. Its important as it helps prevent system specific info or user sensitive files from being committed to a repository, it also helps to keep the repository clean. Some examples include compiled source code, DS_Store files(OS files), .env files, idea folders and intellij output folders.

b) Which Git command allows you to compare the differences between two commits? Explain how you would use it with commit hashes. (3 points)

The git diff command.

Add the SHA values of the commits as arguments for the diff command:

```
git diff 6cdb2 4bcd6u
```

This shows the line-by-line changes.

c) What is the HEAD pointer in Git? Describe its role in navigating commit history and how it changes during operations like checkout, commit, or reset. (3 points)

The HEAD pointer in git is a reference to the latest checked-out branch, representing the commit the working directory is based on. The checkout command moves the HEAD pointer to the selected branch or commit. After a commit is made the HEAD pointer moves to the new commit. The reset command, the HEAD pointer moves either forward or backward to the selected commit.

d) Which Git command can you use to discard changes made to a file in your working directory? Explain what happens to the file after running the command. (3 points)

The git restore command. After use the file is restored to its state from the most recent commit deleting all local changes.

e) What Git command can you use to revert a specific commit? How does this differ from git reset? (3 points)

The git revert command. This command creates a new commit from an old one in order to revert the changes of a specific commit. This is different from git reset which moves the HEAD pointer to the specified commit to allow edits, thereby changing and discarding commit history.

7. Create a GitHub account at <https://github.com> (if you don't have one already) and copy paste your GitHub username in your assignment as an answer to this question. (3 points) [Myriad21](#)

Chrome File Edit View History Bookmarks Profiles Tab Window Help

https://learngitbranching.js.org/ Relaunch to update

Learn Git Branching

Hide Goal Level Push Main! Instructions

```
$ level remoteAdvanced1
$ hint
Remember you can always use the undo
or reset commands
$ delay 2000
$ show goal
$ levels
```

Select a level

Main Remote

Push & Pull -- Git Remotes!

Time to share your 1's and 0's kids; coding just got social

1: Clone Intro

★★★★★★★★

To Origin And Beyond -- Advanced Git Remotes!

And you thought being a benevolent dictator would be fun...

8: Pull arguments

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

Goal To Reach

Notes: only the main branch will be checked in this level. The other branches are simply for reference (shown as dashed labels). You can hide this dialog with "hide goal".

side1
side2
side3
main
main+o/main
C0
C1
C2
C3
C4
C5
C6
C7

Levels · Solution · Reset · Undo · Objective · Help

Chrome File Edit View History Bookmarks Profiles Tab Window Help

https://learngitbranching.js.org/ Relaunch to update

Learn Git Branching

Hide Goal Level Rebase Introduction Instructions

```
$ level intro4
$ hint
Make sure you commit from bugFix fir
$ delay 2000
$ show goal
$ levels
```

Select a level

Main Remote

Introduction Sequence

A nicely paced introduction to the majority of git commands

1: Introduction to Git Commits

★★★★

Ramping Up

The next serving of 100% git awesomes-ness. Hope you're hungry

1: Detach yo' HEAD

1 2 3 4

Moving Work Around

"Git" comfortable with modifying the source tree :P

1: Cherry-pick Intro

1 2

A Mixed Bag

A mixed bag of Git techniques, tricks, and tips

5: Git Describe

1 2 3 4 5

Advanced Topics

For the truly knowled

Goal To Reach

You can hide this window with "hide goal".

C0
C1
C2
C3
C4
C5
C6
C7
main
bugFix*

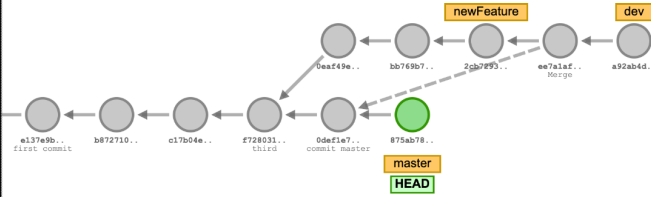
Undo · Objective · Help

Free Explore

```
Have fun!  
$ git log  
> e137e9b first commit  
$ git commit  
$ git commit  
$ git commit -m "third"  
$ git branch dev  
$ git commit -m "commit  
master"  
$ git checkout dev  
$ git commit  
$ git commit  
$ git commit  
$ git log  
> 2cb7293 (no message)  
> bb769b7 (no message)  
> 0eaf49e (no message)  
> f728031 third  
> c17b04e (no message)  
> b872710 (no message)  
> e137e9b first commit  
$ git branch newFeature  
$ git merge master  
$ git commit  
$ git checkout master  
$ git commit  
$ git log  
> 875ab78 (no message)  
> 0def1e7 commit master  
> f728031 third  
> c17b04e (no message)  
> b872710 (no message)  
> e137e9b first commit
```

\$ enter git command

Local Repository
HEAD: master





Git Essential Training: The Basics (2019)

Course completed by Trajuan Smith
Jan 19, 2026 at 01:57AM UTC • 2 hours 55 minutes

Top skills covered

Git

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Shea H.", with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

Shea Hanson, Head of Learning Content Strategy



Certificate ID: 292f9822741efb28148d40f9cef178dcf6ba65adaf061ebc22c2fd318da584fe